

00 A CONCEPT, EXPLAINED —

Essential complexity.

On the model that outlives the tools — from business architecture to code.

Robert Blust · Software Engineer & Architect

RESTS ON `experience Essential Complexity`

From business architecture to code — end-to-end traceability.

Four areas shaped my career: software development, methodology, IT architecture and business architecture. I know all four.

The goal is always end-to-end continuity — from the business domain to implementation. Only the path there was expensive and hard for a long time.

RESTS ON

skill Software engineering

skill Software process engineering

skill Enterprise architecture

skill Business architecture

A model captures a problem in its essential complexity — no more.

Capture the essential, leave out the unimportant. That is the real craft.

My standard for every model, for about 15 years.

RESTS ON

skill Model-driven engineering

experience Eclipse Modeling Platform Working Group

03 ONCE HARD — NOW EASIER —————

BEFORE

UML · SysML · your own DSL

Powerful — but hard, specialized, expensive. Few can read it.

Same precision — far less friction.

RESTS ON

skill Software modeling (UML, SysML, C4)

skill Domain-specific language design

TODAY

AI understands natural language.

With the right meta-model: the facts as Markdown — cheap to create and maintain, readable for everyone.

The Mental Model.

A structured knowledge base — I call it the Mental Model.

Domains & terms

Booking · Finance · Door Access · Task

How we work

Roles · teams · processes with gates

Why this way

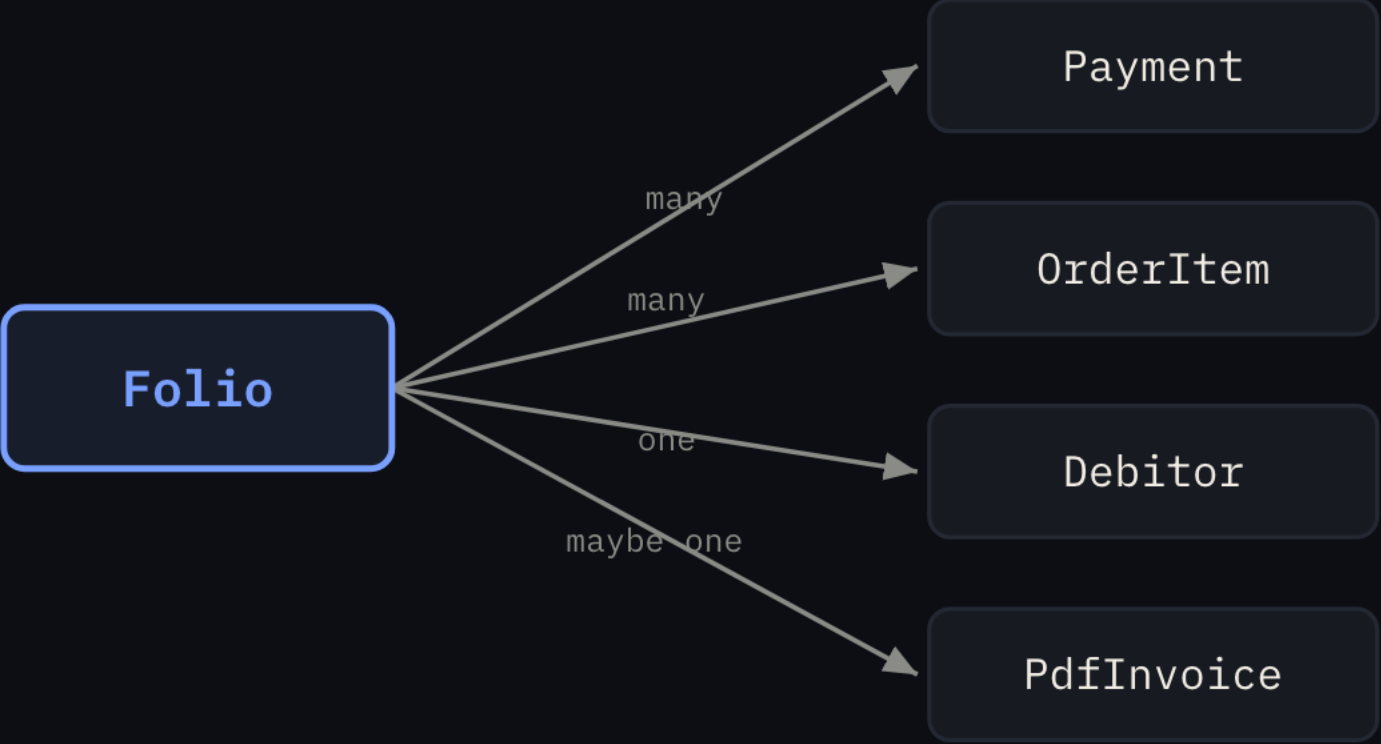
Architecture decisions · rules

How we measure

KPIs

Facts as Markdown · structured by a meta-model · **machine-readable**

RESTS ON `concept Mental Model`



Folio
Financial account of a reservation — bundles all line items of a stay.

OrderItem
A single line item on the folio.

Payment
Payment that settles order items fully or partly.

Debitor
Who owes the bill — person or company.

PdfInvoice
The finalized invoice at check-out.

Real model from LIKE MAGIC – **Markdown + Mermaid**

Every term in one sentence – **no more, no less.**

RESTS ON experience Co-Founder & Head of Technology skill Domain-driven design

One model that everything can be measured against.

- ✓ **Requirements** use only terms from the **glossary** — one language, no synonyms.
- ✓ **Implementation** validated against **glossary + ADRs**.
- ✓ **New terms** must land in the **glossary** first — otherwise no merge.

Not documentation but an artifact to validate against — so that **change gets cheaper and safer**.

RESTS ON skill Requirements engineering skill Domain-driven design

The right context makes AI far more reliable.

A model like the Mental Model gives AI the right context: it does not eliminate hallucinations — but it shrinks the space where AI has to guess, moving it from guessing to grounded reasoning. The cleaner the structure, the better the context. In practice: the Mental Model as a context layer for AI assistants.

RESTS ON

skill Context engineering

kpi Grounded Answer Rate

The pendulum swings — back to spec-driven development.

From “no big design up front” to spec-first — because AI makes specifications fast and affordable.

For years upfront modeling was too expensive, so agile deliberately dropped it. That math has changed.

RESTS ON

skill Spec-driven development

phase Spec

Tools come and go — the model stays.

The standard stays: capture essential complexity. Only now the path is open to everyone.

That is how I still build today: close to the code, but with the model in mind.
Thank you.

RESTS ON `vision One model, true everywhere`